

Biomarker Testing / Basket Clinical Trials / Tissue Agnostic Therapy

Quick Tips – Care Guide



What is Biomarker Testing?

Enhances the diagnosis and treatment of sarcoma in several ways:

- Identifies specific genetic mutations associated with sarcoma
- Helps determine the most effective targeted therapies for individual patients.
- Guides clinical trial eligibility for novel therapies
- Assists in predicting disease progression and response to treatment and Aids in monitoring treatment effectiveness and disease recurrence
- Provides insights into tumor biology for personalized medicine approaches

Biomarker Testing

The First Step

Biomarker testing (also called molecular profiling, comprehensive genomic profiling, or next-generation sequencing) helps identify genetic alterations that may be driving your cancer.

Why it matters

- Essential for patients with rare cancers
- Can be performed using tumor tissue or blood
- Tests hundreds of genes at once, making it more efficient than testing one gene at a time
- May identify biomarkers that could be matched to targeted therapies or clinical trials

Ask your doctor: Have I had comprehensive biomarker testing, and what were the results?

Basket Clinical Trials

Expanding Treatment Options

If biomarker testing identifies a genetic alteration without an FDA-approved treatment, you may qualify for a clinical trial.

What is a basket trial?

A basket trial studies a therapy in patients with different cancer types that share the same genetic mutation or biomarker.

Why consider a basket trial?

- Access to promising new therapies
- May be especially valuable for rare cancers
- Helps advance research and future treatment options
- Can connect patients to therapies matched to their tumor biology

Ask your doctor: Am I eligible for any basket trials based on my biomarker results?

Tissue-Agnostic Therapy

Treating the Biomarker, Not the Tumor Location

Tissue-agnostic therapies target specific genetic alterations regardless of where the cancer started.

What does "tissue-agnostic" mean?

These treatments focus on the tumor's molecular features rather than the organ where the cancer originated.

Why consider tissue-agnostic therapy?

- May be used across multiple cancer types
- Provides a more personalized treatment approach
- Can create options for patients with rare cancers
- Uses biomarker testing results to guide treatment selection

Ask your doctor:

- Do my biomarker results show a targetable genetic alteration?
- Is there an FDA-approved tissue-agnostic therapy for my cancer?
- What benefits and side effects should I expect?
- How is the treatment given (pill, injection, or infusion)?
- Will my insurance cover this therapy?

Your Action Plan

TEST → MATCH → TREAT

TEST: Get comprehensive biomarker testing.

MATCH: Review results with your care team and explore clinical trials.

TREAT: Consider targeted and tissue-agnostic therapies when appropriate.



"Patients cannot wait for trials to be created for every type of cancer. By eliminating the restriction of tumor location and type, tissue-agnostic therapies are revolutionizing personalized medicine."

— Vivek Subbiah, MD, Co-Principal Investigator, TRACK

Important Reminder

The informed consent process continues throughout the study. Your doctor and research team should keep you informed of new information so you can continue making informed decisions about your participation.

Key Takeaway: An informed consent form is designed to help you understand the study, protect your rights, and make the decision that is best for you.

Resources

[Tumor-agnostic baskets to N-of-1 platform trials: Transforming precision oncology clinical trial design](#)

[Why Biomarker Testing Matters for Leiomyosarcoma \(LMS\)](#)

[Biomarker Testing in Rare Cancers](#)

[Circulating Biomarkers in Sarcoma](#)



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